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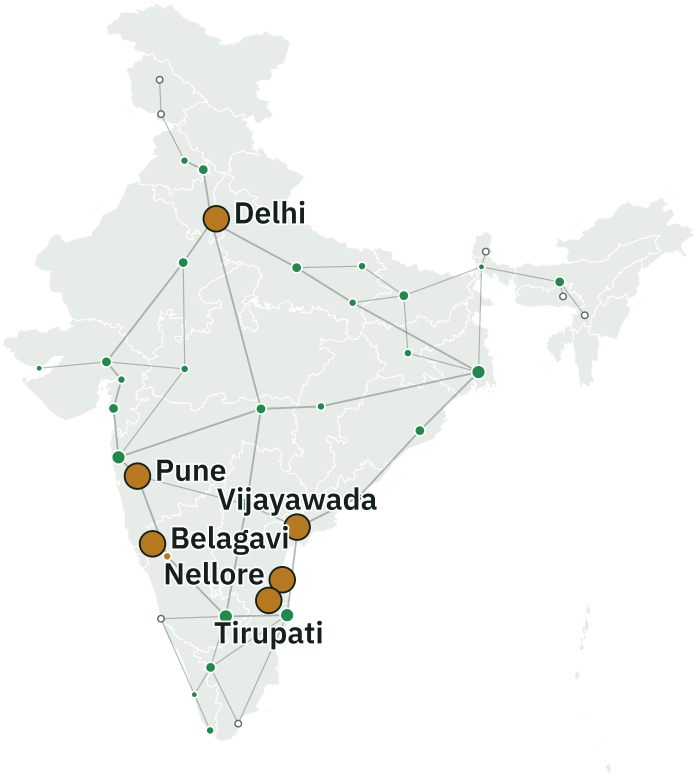
# Second cyclone may cost Nellore and Vijayawada two delivery days

● NETWORK: AMBER

**BEFORE DIWALI · 5 DAYS TO DHANTERAS · 7 DAYS TO DIWALI**

*For e-commerce, D2C and consumer-goods teams delivering orders and stocking shops through Diwali.*

Five days before Dhanteras, IMD expects a new storm, Murasu, to cross the coast between Nellore and Narsapur early on Tuesday as a severe cyclonic storm[1]. Arnab's repairs are barely done, and this one lands further south, on the Chennai–Kolkata trunk road. Elsewhere, Delhi turns away older goods vehicles from today, Pune's old-city markets take trucks only at night, and north Karnataka's cane farmers say they will keep blocking roads.




Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

● GREEN normal for peak week: busy, but delivery promises hold
● AMBER something is slowing deliveries beyond normal peak
● RED deliveries largely stopped across a state or city, or a courier embargo on the route

## DATES THAT MATTER

- **Since Wed 21 Oct** Delhi on Stage I of GRAP, its pollution action plan[2]
- **Until Thu 12 Nov** Pune's old-city markets take goods vehicles only at night
- **Sun 1 Nov** Delhi turns away goods vehicles below BS-VI
- **Mon 2 – Tue 3 Nov** Cyclone Murasu reaches the south Andhra coast
- **Fri 6 – Sat 7 Nov** Warehouse crews leave Delhi, Ludhiana and Mumbai
- **Tue 10 – Sat 14 Nov** Gujarat's markets and transport shut till Labh Pancham
- **Fri 13 – Mon 16 Nov** Chhath keeps east UP and Bihar crews away from city hubs

## DELIVERY PROMISE BY REGION

| North | West | South | East | Northeast | Central |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| +1* | +1* | +2–3* | +0 | +0 | +0 |
| AMBER | AMBER | AMBER | GREEN | GREEN | GREEN |

* Likely impact (#days) on delivery promise up to Diwali within the region, specific to certain cities or pincodes, beyond what is expected for the season.

## Cyclone Murasu heads for the coast between Nellore and Narsapur on Tuesday

South · Coastal Andhra from Nellore to the Godavari mouth, Vijayawada and Guntur inland, and Rayalaseema

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

The depression should reach the sea off Andhra by Monday evening, and the state's disaster authority expects a severe cyclonic storm, The Week reports[3]. No railway or port has announced closures yet. So where does it bite? That depends on where on that long stretch of coast it actually crosses.

- **Nellore, Ongole and the Chennai–Kolkata highway (NH-16)** South · +2 to +3 days Nellore and Prakasam sit at the south end of the landfall stretch, on the east coast's main road and railway. I'd expect NH-16 to crawl or shut on Tuesday, and parcels for both districts to arrive late, on Thursday or Friday.
- **Vijayawada, Guntur and the Krishna delta** South · +2 days IMD's heavy to very heavy rain on Monday and Tuesday falls on Krishna, Guntur, NTR (Vijayawada's district), Palnadu and Bapatla[1]. Vijayawada is where the Chennai, Kolkata and Hyderabad roads meet, so I'd expect loads through it to be held a day, and the delta's deliveries to run late into Thursday.
- **Tirupati, Kadapa and the rest of Rayalaseema** South · +1 day Moderate to heavy rain is forecast across Rayalaseema from Monday to Wednesday[4]. I'd expect a day's delay on the roads inland from Chennai, not more.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

**For e-commerce and D2C teams**

- Add three days to promises for Nellore, Prakasam and Bapatla pin codes from today, and two for Vijayawada, Guntur and Krishna: an order placed after Sunday likely misses Dhanteras there, my estimate.

**For FMCG and consumables distribution**

- Get south coastal Andhra's sweets and dry fruits into town depots before Monday evening; Diwali on Sun 8 Nov leaves one more run after the road reopens.

**What next:** Tamil Nadu has rain forecast from 1 to 6 Nov, and Kerala's hill districts yellow alerts to 4 Nov[3].

## Delhi's borders with Gurugram, Noida and Ghaziabad

North · Only BS-VI, CNG and electric goods vehicles get in from today

AMBER

From today trucks and vans below BS-VI, the newest emission standard, stay out, and trucks not bound for Delhi must take the Peripheral Expressway round it, Outlook reports[5]. I'd expect older vans from the NCR warehouses to be stopped at the border this week, and Delhi's Dhanteras top-ups to slip a day.

## Pune's old-city markets (Laxmi Road and the peths)

West · Goods vehicles from 11 pm to 9 am only, till 12 Nov

AMBER

Since 26 Oct the traffic police have kept goods vehicles off Laxmi Road, Tulshibaug, Mahatma Phule Mandai and the peths by day, loading and unloading included, Free Press Journal reports[6]. It comes every Diwali, mind you. I'd expect shop top-ups there to move to the night, and a van that misses 9 am to wait for the next night.

## Pune–Bengaluru highway (NH-48), Belagavi to Hubballi

South · Cane farmers' blockades; the agitation goes on

AMBER

Yesterday's bandh brought road blockades at several points, a sit-in in front of buses at Belagavi's bus stand and a blocked road at Nigadi near Dharwad, PTI reports[7]. Farmers burned tyres on the Kalaghatgi–Tadas road too[8]. Will it end there? Their leaders say no, not until the state and the mills offer a price[7]. I'd expect more short blockades this week, each costing north Karnataka's vans a day.

SOURCES

Built from public sources only. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. If I am wrong, we'll find out in the subsequent weeks. Cost of delay: High: the delivery misses Dhanteras or Diwali, so the sale is lost or the order comes back; Medium: late, but still before the festival, or stock reaches shops after peak buying; Low: a delay with little effect on sales.


1. Deccan Chronicle: Andhra braces for a severe cyclonic storm, 31 Oct
2. Outlook: GRAP Stage I invoked in Delhi-NCR, 21 Oct
3. The Week: after Arnab, Murasu headed for Andhra, 31 Oct
4. The Hans India: Naidu tells officials to prepare for another cyclone, 1 Nov
5. Outlook: what changes for vehicles in Delhi from 1 Nov, 31 Oct
6. Free Press Journal: Pune bans daytime goods vehicles in central markets till 12 Nov, 28 Oct
7. ThePrint (PTI): cane growers block roads, districts impose restrictions, 31 Oct
8. Deccan Chronicle: road-block protests across north Karnataka, 31 Oct